



MyGurukul

SACRED WISDOM — SATURDAY, FEBRUARY 14, 2026



SACRED TEXT

*aprayatnātprayatnādvā mūḍho nāpnoti nirvṛtim |
tattvaniścayamātreṇa prājño bhavati nirvṛtaḥ | | 18 | 34 | |
śuddhaṃ buddhaṃ priyaṃ pūrṇaṃ niṣprapañcaṃ nirāmayam |
ātmānaṃ taṃ na jānanti tatrābhyāsaparā janāḥ | | 18 | 35 | |
nāpnoti karmaṇā mokṣaṃ vimūḍho+abhyāsarūpiṇā |
dhanyo vijñānamātreṇa muktastiṣṭhatyavikriyaḥ | | 18 | 36 | |*

— Aṣṭāvakra-gītā, Prakaraṇa 18 (Chapter 18), Verses 34-36

GURU'S INTERPRETATION

The path to liberation isn't paved with striving or lack thereof, but with understanding. The fool, whether exerting effort or avoiding it, misses true peace. Only the wise, through the unwavering conviction of truth, finds lasting tranquility. It's not about what you do, but what you *know* yourself to be. This knowing is not intellectual assent, but a deep, abiding realization.

So many are caught in the endless cycle of practice, striving to become something they already are. The verses describe the Self as pure, awakened, beloved, complete, beyond illusion, and free from suffering. Yet, people remain fixated on external practices, missing the inherent perfection within. They dedicate themselves to rituals and disciplines, hoping to achieve what is already their birthright. They fail to recognize the treasure they carry, the Self that is always present, always whole.

Liberation isn't earned through actions or diligent practice for those who are truly ignorant. It's a shift in perspective, a simple recognition of your true nature. Someone blessed understands this and through the knowledge alone, rests in freedom, untouched by the world's drama. This freedom isn't a future state to be attained, but a present reality to be recognized. In modern life, we are bombarded with messages telling us we are not enough, that we need to achieve more, acquire more, *become* more. This teaching from the Aṣṭāvakra-gītā offers a radical counterpoint: you are already complete. Your liberation lies not in endless striving, but in recognizing the inherent wholeness within you, a stillness untouched by the chaos of the world. It invites you to step off the hamster wheel of perpetual self-improvement and simply *be*. The invitation is to recognize the divine essence that is the core of your being.

REFLECTION FOR TODAY

Are you willing to release the illusion that you need to become something you are not, and instead rest in the knowing of your inherent wholeness?